

Breaking rules.

In October, a *New York Times/Siena College poll* asked likely voters whether presidents should (a) “do what they think is best, even if that might go outside of existing rules” or (b) “follow existing rules, even if that prevents them from doing what they think is best.” Thirty-one percent of Trump voters, compared to 12 percent of Harris voters, said presidents should “go outside of existing rules.” Again, that’s about one in three.

Suspending the Constitution.

In October, a *Monmouth University poll* asked: “If Donald Trump did suspend some laws and constitutional provisions if he is elected president, would that bother you a lot, bother you a little, or not bother you at all?” Nearly 60 percent of registered voters said it would bother them a lot. But 40 percent of Republicans and 32 percent of Trump voters said it wouldn’t bother them at all. Only 25 percent of Republicans and 28 percent of Trump voters said it would bother them a lot.

This finding illuminates a second tier of voters who might go along with authoritarianism. In addition to the third of Trump’s supporters who affirmatively want a rule-breaking strongman, another third or more indicate that they won’t complain much if he openly violates laws and the Constitution.



Trumpian Authoritarianism

Power is concentrated in the hands of one person or a very small group.

